



SHIPPED GOODS

CAMELS loaded with watermelons cross the Ganges near Allahabad. With the monsoon still a long month away, the heat wave burning a swathe of misery across central and northern India shows no signs of weakening.

LUCKNOW | Muddied Revival

After launching a special campaign in Uttar Pradesh for recruiting partymen with a "clean image" so as to rise above the so-tainted BSP and SP, Rahul Gandhi has received a shock. His mentor and party leader Digvijay Singh has been "welcoming" criminals into the Congress. Among those "blessed" are hardcore criminal Ajay Rai, an active member of the Brijesh Singh gang of Varanasi; Tulsi Singh Rajput from Gujarat; Kinkar Singh, once most wanted by the police, and Pasi from Unnao. A senior UPCC leader has complained to Rahul and Sonia Gandhi, objecting to Singh's style of functioning. "We will lose our moral fight against the BSP and the SP if we welcome criminals into the Congress," says a senior leader. The Congress' "clean image" in Uttar Pradesh is on the downslide.

by Subhash Mishra



SINGH (RIGHT) WITH RAI

RAHUL GANDHI'S MENTOR DIGVIJAY SINGH HAS BEEN WELCOMING TAINTED PERSONS INTO THE CONGRESS.